

Women in Tech

Insights that inform and educate from
India's leading women techies

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Imaging: Anil VK

I remember vividly during my first semester of engineering college, how there was a disproportionately more number of girls opting for computer science (CS), electronics and telecommunications (EXTC) or information technology (IT) degrees – compared to mechanical or civil engineering degrees. Subsequently, with my sister graduating and earning her engineering degree, I realized the number of girls entering into engineering roles was definitely increasing. That was over twenty years ago. Given my own academic experience, I had no reason to doubt the number of women entering the IT and technology sector workforce was only going to increase.

Of course, subsequently I realized that more girls graduating as computer science engineers from one batch of one college in India wasn't necessarily translating into more women getting IT industry jobs. Even the 2021-2022 BridgeLabz survey on tech employability revealed that women are still underrepresented in the tech sector, with 21 per cent women in roles of IT executives, 13 per cent in business operations, 13 per cent in project and programme management, 3 per cent in cloud computing, 2 per cent in DevOps, and just 1 per cent in Cybersecurity roles. The survey further showcased that 79 per cent of women employed in tech roles

were actually in non-tech companies. In comparison, the IT services sector, despite being the largest reported industry in the survey, has only 21 per cent women population. This is shocking!

While we can't fix this immediately, we can surely learn from what senior women leaders in tech have to say by acknowledging their truths and experience, challenges and opportunities. Over the next 10 pages, my attempt is to highlight the past and present of over 10 senior women tech leaders to positively inform and educate the future trajectory of women in the tech industry, and help create more awareness.

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